



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Talking about time!



Learning Outcome

Exchange information about hypothetical situations in written and spoken interactions according to work and social contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about relationships and character traits.
- I can talk about impossible situations.
- I can use colloquial expressions.

Ask your partner:

- What do you do to kill time?
- William Penn said: "Time is what we want most, but what we use worst." What do you think this means?





Let's Explore!

Vanessa has been having a tough time at work. She is really **burning the candle at both ends***.

* "To burn the candle at both ends" means to work or do other things from early in the morning until late at night and so get very little rest.

Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Vanessa:** Amy, I'm sorry I'm pressed for time today.
Amy: That's OK. We have lots of time. We won't run out of time, so take your time.
Vanessa: I had a terrible day at work yesterday. I really think I'm starting to lose it.
Amy: What happened?
Vanessa: I had some people quit on me. I was just trying to establish some orderliness and they thought my demands were unreasonable. So in the last two days, I have canned a supplier and had three employees quit. It's been an appalling week so far. Perhaps I'm too strict?
Amy: If you hadn't created rules, there would have been no discipline. Had people quit before?
Vanessa: Sure. Just not so hysterically.
Amy: I'm curious Vanessa. What was your background before you started this job?
Vanessa: I was a chef. I studied at the Blue Ribbon Institute in San Francisco. If I hadn't studied there, I probably would have never gotten into the restaurant business. Also, if I hadn't gone out to the west coast, I would have never seen how beautiful California is. Have you been?
Amy: No.
Vanessa: It's gorgeous. I lived in San Francisco for nine months before I got homesick and came back to Boston.
Amy: Are you from here?
Vanessa: No, the UK. I settled here after school.
Amy: How long did you work as a sous-chef?
Vanessa: Six months. I would have gotten really good, if I had worked as sous-chef a little longer.
Amy: Did you enjoy it?
Vanessa: I had a great time there. I really liked San Francisco too, but it's too far. If my friends had lived somewhere closer, I would have stayed out there.
Amy: Have you ever wondered what your life would have been like if you had stayed in San Francisco? Have you ever wondered what your life would have been like if you had remained a sous-chef? My point is, I wonder if managing is truly making you happy. Maybe you should take some time away?
Vanessa: I don't know. I guess I have been under a lot of pressure lately and that's why I'm thinking the way I am.
Amy: Are you burning out?
Vanessa: Maybe. I sometimes wonder if I have worked too much this past year. I suppose I have burned the candle at both ends for a little long now.
Amy: Vanessa, do the life balance wheel for me.



Let's Practice!

Vanessa and Amy talk about what would happen if they had done things differently.

Instructions: Proofread the sentences. Circle the incorrect words. Write the correct words above to complete the sentence. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. If you hadn't create rules, there will have been no discipline.
2. If I hadn't study there, I probably would have never get into the restaurant business.
3. If I hadn't go out to the west coast, I would have never see how beautiful California is.
4. I would have gotten really good, if I had work as a sous-chef a little longer.
5. If my friends had living somewhere closer, I would have staying out there.



Let's Practice!

Vanessa talks about her employees.

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentence. Write each word to place it in the correct order. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. really / lose / starting / think / I'm / to / it. / I

2. I / trying / some / to / was / establish / just / orderliness.

3. thought / They / my / were / unreasonable. / demands

4. Perhaps / strict? / too / I'm





Extension Activity

Learn idioms about time!

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Research two English idioms about time.
- Make a PowerPoint presentation.
- In your presentation, use a conversation, pictures, or other media to explain the meaning of the idiom and its use(s).
- Present your idioms.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I research two English time idioms.

☐ ☐

I create a PowerPoint presentation that creatively explains the time idiom and its uses.

☐ ☐

I present my idioms in a clear and concise manner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **starting to lose it** (expression): to get mad at someone or lose your patience with them
e.g. I'm starting to lose it.
- **to can** (verb): to dismiss someone from their job
e.g. I have canned a supplier and had three employees quit.
- **appalling** (adjective): very bad
e.g. It's been an appalling week so far.
- **hysterically** (adverb): unable to control your feelings or behavior because you are extremely frightened, angry, excited, etc.
e.g. Just not so hysterically.
- **unreasonable** (adjective): not fair or acceptable
e.g. They thought my demands were unreasonable.
- **orderliness** (noun): the state of being organized neatly
e.g. I was just trying to establish some orderliness.





Learning Points

The Unreal Past: Impossible Situation

When you talk about the unreal past, you express things that did not happen in reality in the past. You use past tenses to talk about unreal situations.

You use the **Type 3 Conditional** to express conditions in the past that did not happen or to express criticism or regret with **would have**, **could have** or **should have**.

Structure:

If + subject + Past Perfect, subject + Perfect Conditional

Example:

*If my employees **had studied** at the Blue Ribbon, they **wouldn't have quit** so easily.*

The condition of having studied at the Blue Ribbon is unreal. As a result, they have quit too easily.

Examples:

- If you **hadn't created** rules, there **would have been** no discipline.
- If I **hadn't studied** there, I probably **would have never gotten** into the restaurant business.
- Also, if I **hadn't gone** out to the west coast, I **would have never seen** how beautiful California is.
- I **would have gotten** really good if I **had worked** as a sous-chef a little longer.
- If my friends **had lived** somewhere closer, I **would have stayed** out there.





Learning Points

Colloquial Expressions about Time

Colloquial expressions are idioms that you use frequently, especially in spoken English. There are many expressions that refer to time in English.

Colloquial expressions about time can refer to different aspects of time. Here are some colloquial expressions:

Lack of time:

pressed for time

run out of time

Have enough time:

lots of time

take your time

The right time for something:

a great time

Examples:

- I had a **great time** there.
- I'm sorry I'm **pressed for time** today.
- That's OK. We have **lots of time**.
- We won't **run out of time**, so **take your time**.

